NAGA6211 P1

Ember Willow Jones, ST10450923

Devilliers Cloete, ST10443944



Figure 1: Title Screen (Cloete,2025)

Title **3**
Genre, platform and target audience **3**
One-liner description **3**
One-liner comparison **3**
Gameplay and mechanics **4**
Combat 4
Exploration 4
Progression 4
Setting **5**
The Hub 5
The Shallows 6
The Depths 7
Story **7**
Characters **9**
Main Character: Siya Rhaxo 9
Crafting NPC: Martyn Diederiks 10
Merchant NPC: Asmi Padayachee 11
Reference List **12**
List of Figures **12**

Title

Godsaw

Genre, platform and target audience

Genre: Action-platformer, ARPG
Platform: Console and PC
Target Audience: Young adults (17+) who enjoy challenging action-adventure games with a strong emphasis on skill-based combat, parrying, and exploration. The game appeals to players who appreciate its unique setting. As well as players who enjoy a unique and engaging story.

One-liner description

An action-platformer in which an impulsive explorer fights unique marine creatures while traveling through the seas of this post-apocalyptic world, in order to learn more about the downfall of civilization.

One-liner comparison

An action-platformer similar to *Dead Cells* (Motion Twin, 2018), with a fixed character who fights unique marine enemies while exploring the seas of this post-apocalyptic world to learn more about the downfall of civilization.

Gameplay and mechanics

Combat

The player has two weapons and a dash which can be used to dodge attacks.
Primary weapons are melee range, damage-focused, and consist of swords, daggers or spears.
Secondary weapons are utility-focused and can be ranged. They consist of harpoons (pull enemies closer), throwing nets (slow or root enemies in place) and shields (block ranged attacks).
The player will also have consumable items, such as healing herbs.
Healing herbs will regenerate the player's health over a short period of time, but stop working when the player takes damage. This reflects the fact that nature takes time to heal, and that when we interrupt it we put ourselves in danger.

There are unique enemies and NPCs in each level/biome, reflecting the environment.
In the Reef area, enemies are smaller and faster and the player faces multiple enemies at a time and the player must deal with frequent attacks from different directions.

In the Depths biome the player faces larger, slower enemies that deal more damage. This makes getting hit by attacks more punishing, incentivising the player to focus on timing their dodges and attacks well. This gives the combat a rhythm which builds tension in this dangerous area.

Exploration

While exploring the world the player will find areas that require certain tools to access. The tools can be found in different levels, giving the player something to look forward to when they return to the area once they find the tool they need to access it.
While exploring these areas, players will find weapons, scraps and lore items. Each of these will contain flavour text, allowing the player to slowly put together pieces of the world that they are exploring.

Progression

As players explore the different areas they will find scrap and lore items. Scrap can be used to forge new weapons and tools for combat and exploration respectively. The lore items that the player finds along their journey will grant them additional information about how the world that they are in came to be and what caused the apocalypse.

The player will talk to the relevant NPCs in order to gain progression.
Talking to Martyn Diederiks will allow the player to forge Scraps into new weapons and tools, and talking to Asmi Padayachee will allow the player to gain healing herbs.

Setting

Decades after the apocalypse, a wounded world begins its slow, painful healing. The cataclysm, a maelstrom of colossal floods, shattering earthquakes, and violent storms have radically reshaped the coasts and continents. In the newly warmed and polluted seas, enormous algae blooms choke the waterways, and from these toxic depths, a monstrous new era of flora and fauna is emerging, creeping from the ocean onto the land. Your journey begins on a fragile hub, one of the last bastions of humanity, perched precariously between the ruins of the old world and the terrifying promise of the new.

The Hub

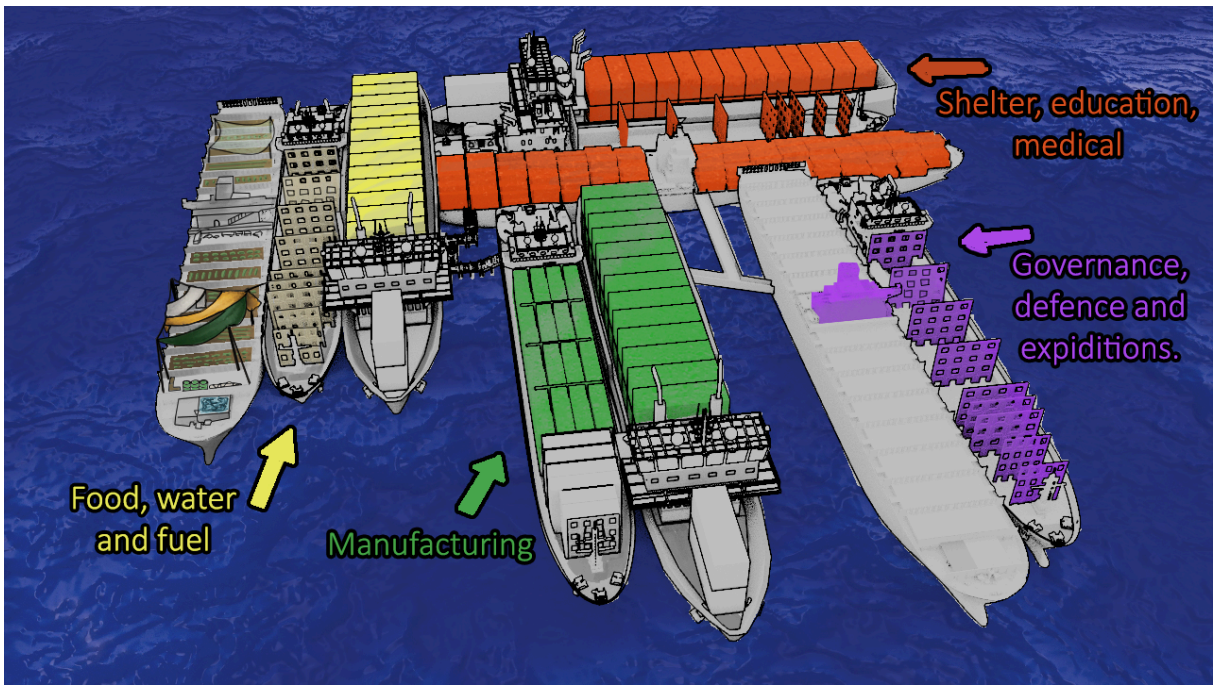


Figure 2: Diagram of Varuna Island. (Cloete,2025)

figure
Varuna Island is the name of this floating sanctuary, a community built upon a chain of ten repurposed container ships lashed together. It is a beacon of survival in a drowned world and the player's safe haven between expeditions.
Each section of the island serves a critical function:

- The agrideck: This ship is responsible for producing food, clean water, and bio-fuel. Here, the player can cultivate strange plants discovered while exploring and deliver organic matter from creatures for processing.
- The forge: The manufacturing heart of Varuna, containing smelters, workshops, and central resource storage. This is where the player crafts new tools, upgrades their equipment, and accesses a personal storage locker.
- The commons: The domestic area where the inhabitants live, eat, and sleep. The player can visit the infirmary here to acquire healing items and rest before a journey.
- The command deck: The governance and mission control section. This is where the player selects new missions and engages in critical story-driven conversations, often deciding the future of the community based on discoveries made in the field.

The Shallows

The mission begins here, in the deceptive light of the sun-filtered waters. This is a domain of razor-edged coral, the haunting skeletons of a drowned world, and jagged rock formations that hide both promise and peril. Though the depths hold larger terrors, the shallows are a frantic hunting ground, teeming with smaller, agile sea life that swarm in a constant, desperate struggle to make a meal of you.



Figure 3: Player boat on water. (Cloete,2025)

The Depths

A crushing blackness where light fails and life starves. In these profoundly isolated trenches, the ocean's most warped and terrifying leviathans have evolved in endless nights. Here, survival is a constant test against primordial giants. But for those who can withstand the pressure, the abyss offers the greatest rewards: priceless resources and the dark, foundational truths of the new world.



Figure 4: Enemies found in the ocean. (Cloete, 2025)

Story

As the unchecked consumption of fossil fuels pushed the planet toward collapse, the relentless burning of coal for energy and plastic production choked the atmosphere and deepened the social divide. A tiny elite, consolidating immense wealth and power, engineered a docile and divided populace. To maintain control, they orchestrated endless ‘bread and circuses’, fostering infighting and cultural decay. The final blow to the collective human spirit was the rise of generative AI, which rendered uniquely human endeavors like art obsolete. Society now valued an endless, tailored feed of content that catered to individual biases over art that demanded genuine engagement, critical thought, and emotional connection.

The ruling class, fully aware that their actions were triggering an irreversible climate catastrophe, prepared for the end in secret. They constructed massive, self-sufficient underground bunkers in geologically stable locations, planning to wait out the apocalypse in safety and comfort. When the first signs of collapse began—persistent flooding and superstorms in regions the powerful could easily ignore—they simply retreated underground, abandoning the rest of humanity to its fate.

The calamity unfolded with deceptive slowness. Coastal cities flooded, and climate refugees migrated en masse, straining global resources and sparking heightened tensions. Despite the obvious crisis, a desperate collective denial took hold. Hate crimes and fascist rhetoric skyrocketed as societies fractured. Soon, rising temperatures and resource scarcity led to widespread death and disease. Through it all, the ghost of global trade persisted; immense

container ships, often with no fuel to return home, sat dormant in harbors like Cape Town, their crews trapped.

As desperation on land reached a fever pitch, violent clashes erupted between extremist groups and starving populations. The crews of these stranded ships, forced to defend themselves, made a fateful decision: to pull their vessels further out to sea, using smaller boats for risky supply runs to shore. Over time, they were joined by civilians they met on these expeditions, forming a new, floating community. When all attempts to refuel failed, the captains devised a solution: they drew the massive ships closer together, using shipping containers and makeshift pathways to create a stable, isolated island in the sea.

This new world was immediately tested by cataclysmic storms—biblical in their fury—that finally destroyed the Cape Town harbor in a massive, unexplained explosion. With no home to return to, the islanders embraced their fate. Their first years were spent in survival mode, meticulously sorting through the vast cargo holds for food, tools, and supplies. A diverse population of global refugees pooled their skills, and soon, life became not just bearable, but sustainable. Children were born, a true generation of the sea.

In their isolation, a unique culture emerged. The mix of languages, religions, and histories slowly consolidated into a new belief system, one focused on the palpable fear of their new world. Their deities became generically divine, stripped of specific dogma but centered on the apocalypse they had endured and the heavenly wrath that manifested in the violent storms. This fear-based faith dominated daily life for decades.

Eventually, necessity forced their hand. The floating city required repairs for which they lacked the materials, and the storms had finally subsided to a seasonal pattern. The community decided to send out scouts on refitted lifeboats to explore the new world and gather crucial supplies. This is where the game begins.

You are one of these scouts, sailing into unknown waters. The journey is perilous, filled with monstrous, mutated sea creatures that must be fought for survival. Your mission is to gather resources for the island and, ultimately, to discover what remains of the world.

Unbeknownst to you, the wealthy elites were never merely hiding. Their plan was always to actively orchestrate a global reset. They forced the world's top scientists to continue their research in the bunkers with a simple ultimatum: serve or die. Their goal was to uproot all law and order, allowing civilization to burn in chaos so they could later emerge to rebuild a world in their own image. Growing impatient with the planet's slow recovery, they deployed massive geoengineering structures across the globe—enormous machines designed to scrub carbon and pollution from the atmosphere and rapidly restore habitability.

Their most perfect and terrifying invention is the Deos Speculum: a god-like quantum computer powered by a formidable AI, designed to be a puppet master for the new human population, an artificial deity to enforce their rule. As the player, your journey will feel like a profound religious experience, where the lines between reality and divine intervention are blurred. You will gradually uncover the existence of the Speculum and the horrific truth of the planned reset, setting the stage for a confrontation in a future chapter. This game is about discovery; the battle for the soul of the new world is yet to come.

Characters

Main Character: Siya Rhaxo

Born on Varuna Island 28 years ago, Siya's resilience was forged in the same fires she would later tend. She developed a precocious affinity for smithing and fishing, her innate curiosity driving her to scavenge discarded metal and wire to build whatever contraption sprang into her mind. Under the patient guidance of Martyn, she learned to channel her restless energy into shaping cold, hard steel—a discipline that became the one thing that could truly focus her impulsive nature.

That impulsiveness often manifested as a disregard for rules and schedules; she would frequently vanish to the outskirts of the island, drawn by the call of the open water. While other children attended lessons, she was alone on the makeshift walkways, fishing in silent patience or diving fearlessly into the unpredictable currents, learning the ocean's rhythms firsthand.

This wasn't mere neglect of her education, but a deeper, more visceral form of learning—one built on instinct, trial, and error.



Figure 5: Siya Rhaxo concept art (Cloete,2025)

It was this very combination of traits—her resilient adaptability to any situation and her impulsive willingness to leap into the unknown—that made her the ideal candidate to venture beyond the safety of Varuna. She wasn't just resourceful with materials; she was resourceful with chaos, able to think on her feet and turn sudden disasters into narrow opportunities. The elders knew that to navigate the terrifying new world, they needed someone who wasn't just strong, but unpredictably and brilliantly brave.

Crafting NPC: Martyn Diederiks

As the master of the Forge, Martyn’s unparalleled skill in smithing, repair, and resource management makes him vital to Varuna Island’s survival. He carries himself with a quiet, intimidating authority, his sharp looks are accented by the soot and scars of his trade—only reinforcing his formidable presence.

This combination of indispensability and attractiveness has bred a pronounced arrogance; he is acutely aware that the colony needs him, and he seldom hides his condescension toward those he deems less capable.

Though many find him abrasive, his ego has cost him little socially. He maintains a detached existence from the community he serves, having converted an old ship’s bridge into a private residence that overlooks the island—a literal and symbolic elevation above everyone else. His respect is hard-earned, but his results are undeniable, ensuring his place remains unchallenged.



Figure 6: Martyn Diederiks concept art (Cloete,2025)

Merchant NPC: Asmi Padayachee

Asmi is the oldest and most cherished soul on Varuna Island. In her long and purposeful youth, she was a pillar of the community, serving as both a spiritual guide within the island's humble chapel and a dedicated educator to generations of children. As age gradually slowed her steps but never her spirit, she willingly traded the classroom for the agrideck, retiring to the work of tending the gardens and nurturing the crops that sustain them all.
Now, she spends her days as the gentle, watchful guardian of life on Varuna. She is most content surrounded by young listeners, who gather at her feet not for formal lessons, but for the priceless oral history she embodies.



Figure 7: Asmi Padayachee concept art (Cloete,2025)

Reference List

- Motion Twin. 2018. Dead Cells [Online Digital Game], PlayStation 4. France: Motion Twin.

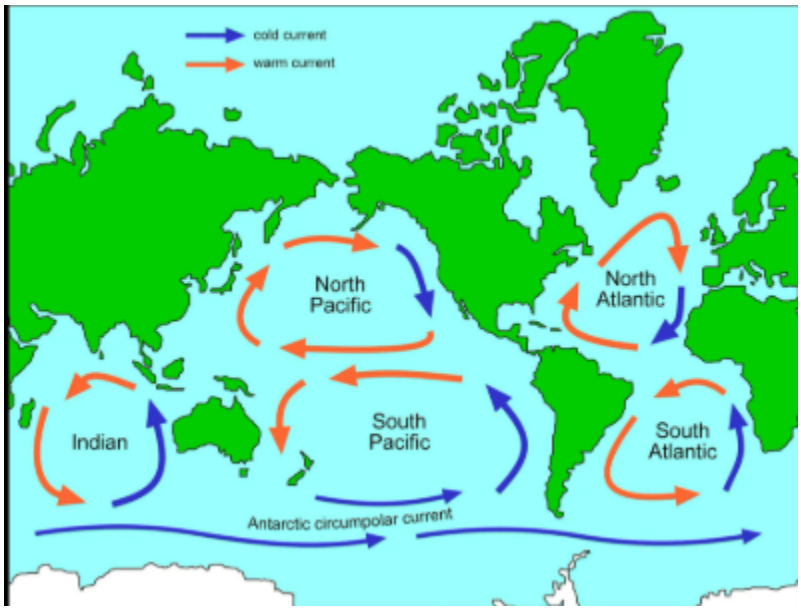
List of Figures

- Figure 1: Cloete,D. 2025. *Title Screen.*
- Figure 2: Cloete,D. 2025. *Diagram of Varuna Island*.
- Figure 3: Cloete,D. 2025. *Player boat on water.*
- Figure 4: Cloete,D. 2025. *Enemies found in the ocean.*
- Figure 5. Cloete,D. 2025. *Siya Rhaxo concept art.*
- Figure 6: Cloete,D. 2025. *Martyn Diederiks concept art.*
- Figure 7: Cloete,D. 2025. *Asmi Padayachee concept art.*

What are we actually going to do:

An ocean/underwater based rougelike (similar to Hades/2)

End goal?
Find the godsaw? Most of the game takes place in south africa, specifically cape town so how will we end up in the northern hemisphere? Currents draggin the island up?



Float up with the currents? Or should the whole game take place in cape town and then for the ending be spirited away to the palace?